

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **French prosecutors** summoned Elon Musk to Paris to face preliminary criminal charges in a sprawling investigation into his social-media platform, X. **A1**
- ◆ **The S&P 500 and Nasdaq** retreated from records set the previous session, shedding 0.4% and 0.1%, respectively, while the Dow fell 0.6%. **B9**
- ◆ **U.S. jobless claims** rose last week but remained relatively low as employers refrained from widespread layoffs. **A2**
- ◆ **Shell traders took** advantage of whipsawing oil prices sparked by the Iran war to lead the British energy company's earnings to the best quarter in two years. **B9**
- ◆ **Shares of national-security-satellite company HawkEye 360** jumped in their public-market debut, underlining investor demand for defense-related companies. **B4**
- ◆ **Rheinmetall said it** aims to start production of cruise missiles with Dutch defense-technology company Destini as early as this year. **B5**
- ◆ **McDonald's executives** said the chain's efforts to reclaim its reputation for affordable food were helping to draw diners and it would keep offering deals. **B3**
- ◆ **Six Flags reported** higher first-quarter revenue as attendance and customer spending swelled and said that its chief financial officer, Brian Witherow, was stepping down. **B2**
- ◆ **Citigroup used its** first investors' day in four years to signal that the bank has turned a corner in its efforts to dig out from its position as a Wall Street laggard. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **A federal trade court** ruled that Trump didn't have the authority to impose new global tariffs after a previous set of levies was struck down by the Supreme Court in February. **A1**
- ◆ **Saudi Arabia and Kuwait** lifted restrictions on the U.S. military's use of their bases and airspace imposed after the start of the U.S. operation to reopen the Strait of Hormuz. **A1, A9**
- ◆ **Rubio discussed Middle East peace** with Pope Leo in talks that followed Trump's criticism of the pontiff. **A6**
- ◆ **Trump and Brazil's** leftist president, Lula, met at the White House in an attempt to repair frayed relations. **A6**
- ◆ **A U.K. immigration official** and a Hong Kong trade official were found guilty of helping China spy on dissidents in Britain. **A7**
- ◆ **GOP lawmakers** in Tennessee approved a new U.S. House map that carves up a majority-Black district in Memphis, part of the Trump strategy to hold on to seats. **A5**
- ◆ **Russian air defenses** shot down 347 Ukrainian drones, Moscow said, in what appeared to be a major attack after Russia spurned Kyiv's cease-fire this week. **A8**
- ◆ **A South Korean** appeals court cut the prison sentence of a former prime minister convicted of rebellion for his role in a failed declaration of martial law. **A7**
- ◆ **Powerful storms** that spawned at least three tornadoes injured at least 17 people in Mississippi. **A5**

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Rubio Visit Aims to Ease Tensions



SHANE BISCUTTO/VATICAN MEDIA/REUTERS

GIFT OF GAB: On a trip to soothe relations between the Trump administration and the Vatican, Secretary of State Marco Rubio gave a football paperweight to Pope Leo XIV, a Chicago White Sox fan. 'You're a baseball guy,' Rubio said, but the football had the State Department seal. **A6**

Gulf States Lift Restrictions On U.S. Bid to Open Strait

Saudi Arabia and Kuwait have lifted restrictions on the U.S. military's use of their bases and airspace imposed after the start of the U.S. operation to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, U.S. and Saudi officials said, and the

By Lara Seligman, Summer Said, Shelby Holliday and Costas Paris

Trump administration is looking to resume its efforts to guide commercial ships through the vital waterway. It isn't clear when the resumption could happen, though

Pentagon officials gave a timeline of as early as this week. The initial effort with naval and air support was paused after 36 hours this week. Iran on Thursday launched missiles, drones and small-boat attacks at U.S. warships near the strait, and the U.S. responded by intercepting the threats and striking Iranian military sites responsible for the attacks, U.S. Central Command said. Iranian state media reported that Iran's military fired ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and suicide drones at the warships in retaliation for

a U.S. attack on an Iranian oil tanker. The U.S. fired disabling shots at a tanker this week that it said was trying to breach the blockade. After Iran fired at the warships, the U.S. targeted Iranian missile and drone launch sites, command and control locations and intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance nodes, Centcom said. Explosions were reported at several sites near the strait. No U.S. assets were struck, Centcom said. Please turn to page A9

◆ **Early effort to reopen the strait illustrates perils....** A9

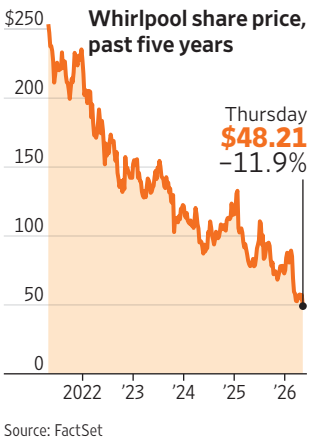
Putin's Strongman Image Ebbs As Ukraine Hits Russia

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

Ever since coming to power more than a quarter-century ago, President Vladimir Putin of Russia has built a state religion around May 9, the anniversary of the Soviet victory over Nazi Germany and the holiest day in the Russian calendar. On Saturday, Putin will preside over a Victory Day parade for the first time since his war on Ukraine went beyond the length of the Soviet Union's war on the Nazis. He has no victories to celebrate. Persistent Ukrainian drone strikes across Russia, including on the capital, have forced Putin to ask for a cease-fire for the duration of the festivities. Parade organizers, citing security threats, have also downgraded the event, eliminating the display of armored vehicles and the march by military cadets. Cellphone and internet services are slated to be disrupted in Moscow for days. With the front line stalled, Russian casualties topping one million, the economy suffering and missile and drone strikes becoming commonplace, a deep sense of discontent has spread through the country in recent months. It potentially poses the gravest challenge to Putin's rule so far—and might be more insidious than the aborted putsch by warlord Yevgeny Prigozhin in 2023. Please turn to page A8

Whirlpool Halts Payout

Whirlpool suspended its dividend, sending its shares down sharply Thursday. **B1**



Musk Faces Criminal Charges In France as Part of Probe of X

By SAM SCHECHNER

PARIS—French prosecutors are summoning Elon Musk to the French capital again—this time to face preliminary criminal charges in a sprawling investigation into his social-media platform, X. The new summons, just weeks after Musk didn't show up for a voluntary interview with French prosecutors, escalates a trans-Atlantic feud over France's handling of its long-running probe of X. It also underscores a growing divergence between the U.S. and

Europe over how—and whether—tech platforms like X should police online speech. The U.S. Justice Department declined last month to cooperate with the French investigation and called it a “politically charged criminal proceeding aimed at wrongfully regulating through prosecution the business activities of a social media platform.” That came after a February raid on X's Paris offices by French law enforcement and prosecutors seeking evidence in their probe. The investigation, which be-

gan in 2025 with allegations of a biased algorithm, has since grown to include charges of violating the secrecy of correspondence, dissemination of child pornography and the creation of sexualized deepfake images by its Grok chatbot. Prosecutors said Thursday that the probe was now an official criminal investigation. They added that Musk is being invited, along with X's former Chief Executive Linda Yaccarino, to appear in court. Please turn to page A9

◆ **SpaceX cranks up spending ahead of IPO...** B1

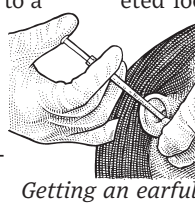
A Beauty-Obsessed Country Has a Hot New Look: Elf Ears

South Koreans say artificial enhancements have a face-slimming effect; \$70 injections

By SOOYOUNG RHEE AND TIMOTHY W. MARTIN

SEOUL—Jung Da-yun didn't quite like what she saw in the mirror. Her ears weren't big enough. She booked a visit to a South Korean clinic offering “elf ear” injections. For about \$70, a plastic surgeon injected the ridged cartilage of her ears with a hyaluronic-acid filler that caused them to perk up. For the first time, they became noticeable straight-on, protruding outward and appearing to sit

higher on her face. Her face looked slimmer, younger and more proportional. “I was very happy with the results,” said Jung, a 31-year-old influencer. Elf ears are suddenly a coveted look in beauty-obsessed South Korea, where residents seem to be on a never-ending quest for cosmetic improvements. Larger ears can create the illusion of a smaller face—a prized trait in East Asia where big heads aren't usually a big plus. Japanese use handheld



Getting an earful

U.S. Takes on Role Of Activist Investor

The government's reach for stakes in companies has businesses scrambling

There is free-market capitalism and state capitalism. Now, there's Trump capitalism.

By Maggie Severns, Gavin Bade, Josh Dawsey and Meridith McGraw

In recent months, the president has extended his hand into American business in unorthodox and, to some corporate leaders, alarming ways—from progressive-style demands to cap credit-card rates to assertive deals grabbing government shares

in private companies. Some executives are so worried Trump will ask for a stake in their company that they have prepared for Oval Office meetings by rehearsing what they would say to fend off the president's advances, lobbyists involved in the preparations said. Others welcome Trump's attention. United Airlines CEO Scott Kirby appealed to Trump with the idea of creating a “national champion” airline during meetings with Trump and top officials at the White House, people fa-

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